MEAL IN ONE PAGE

Monitoring, Evaluation, Accountability & Learning Reference Sheet | International Development & Public Health

1. THE FOUR PILLARS OF MEAL

Monitoring (Continuous)

Routine, ongoing tracking of inputs, activities, outputs, and routine operational parameters during project implementation to ensure plans remain on schedule.

Evaluation (Periodic)

Systematic assessment at specific milestones (baseline, mid-term, endline) to measure relevance, effectiveness, efficiency, impact, and sustainability.

Accountability (Community-Centric)

Ensuring transparent information sharing, active community participation, and responsive Feedback & Complaints Mechanisms (FCM) for affected populations.

Learning (Adaptive)

Capturing data-driven insights, success stories, and failures to inform adaptive management, refine strategy, and improve future program designs.

2. HOW TO WRITE A HIGH-QUALITY INDICATOR

The Standard Indicator Formula:

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[Direction] + [Target Population] + [Variable/Outcome] + [Location] + [Timeline]
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SMART Criteria Check: Specific (What exactly changes?), Measurable (Quantifiable baseline/target), Achievable (Realistic resource allocation), Relevant (Aligned to goal), Time-bound (Clear deadline).

Example Output Indicator: "Number of primary healthcare workers in Rural District X trained on infection control by Q3 2026."

Example Outcome Indicator: "% increase in under-5 malnutrition screening rate across 12 targeted clinics within 12 months."

3. SIMPLE RESULTS FRAMEWORK MATRIX

LEVEL	DEFINITION	EXAMPLE INDICATOR	DATA SOURCE / MOV
Impact (Goal)	Long-term systemic change in health status or child rights.	% reduction in under-5 infant mortality rate across target province.	DHS Surveys, National Health Registry
Outcome	Medium-term behavioral, institutional, or performance shifts.	% of target mothers practicing exclusive breastfeeding for 6 months.	Baseline/Endline Household Surveys
Output	Direct tangible deliverables produced by activities.	# of community health workers certified in infant nutrition counseling.	Training Attendance Logs, Pre/Post Tests
Activity / Input	Actions taken and financial/human resources deployed.	$ deployed; # of nutrition workshops conducted in Q2.	Financial Audits, Activity Reports

4. KEY MEAL CHECKLIST FOR PROGRAM MANAGERS

- **Establish Baselines Early:** Collect quantitative data before project kickoff to measure meaningful change.
- **Data Protection & Ethics:** Secure PII (Personally Identifiable Information) and mandate informed consent.
- **Close the Feedback Loop:** Review community complaints monthly and report actions taken back to beneficiaries.
- **Conduct After-Action Reviews (AAR):** Document key operational lessons at key project milestones.